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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR/ IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION
NOVEMBER 2025

First Semester

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG1DSCTRS100 –

MALAYALAM LITERATURE IN ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Scheme of Valuation

PART A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer All Questions. Each Question carries 1 mark.

1. c) The translator interprets deeper meanings and cultural nuances. [U]/{CO1}
2. c) Her relationship with Kunjakko [An]/{CO2}
3. b) Aisha [K]/{CO3}
4. d) Chemmeen [K]/{CO4}
5. b) Leech [An]/{CO2}
6. b) Symbolic Capital [K]/{CO1}
7. b) for conducting exorcism on her [U]/{CO3}
8. a) Kunjakko [An]/{CO2}
9. c) She retains it as it is [An]/{CO2}
10. b) Kunjutachumma [An]/{CO3}

[10x1 = 10]

PART B

Objective Type Questions

Answer any 10 Questions in a Word or Sentence. Each Question carries1mark.

11. Proud of being 'Anamakkars' descendents. [An]/{CO3}
12. K Satchidanandan [An]/{CO2}
13. Feels betrayed, angry, frustrated - developments posed threats to livelihood of fisherfolk community - affected the nature of the sea. [An]/{CO4}
14. Defining the nature - conditions of translation equivalence. [U]/{CO1}
15. Gopi sir confessed his love to her - she declined - his reply implied he knew her secrets – she was not going to get pregnant. [An]/{CO2}
16. Replacement of SL textual material by equivalent TL textual material, at only one level - translation performed only at the phonological or at the graphological level, or at one of the two levels of grammar and lexis. [U]/ {CO1}
17. Three people from far away - an elderly man, an elderly woman, and a small woman - all kafirs. [An]/{CO3}
18. Prevailing socio political and cultural context [U]/{CO1}
19. Thankamani - fully pregnant - dangerous for her to be out at night. [An]/ {CO2}
20. To appease the water demon and the spirits of dead great-grand uncles [An]/ {CO2}
21. She asked God "How the hell does an untouchable woman become sister to a Christian" [An]/ {CO2}
22. Luttappi, Silly booby [K]/ {CO3}

[10x1 = 10]

PART C

Short Answer Type Questions
Answer any 5 Questions each in 50 Words. Each Question carries 2 marks

23 "Semantics" - study of meanings of words - title highlights how words can create misunderstanding between people - shows that language and meaning are closely linked - poet uses the title to stress the importance of love and understanding over mere words - apt and meaningful - reflects the central idea of the poem - power of words and their meanings. [An]/{CO3}

24. Husband's death leaves her lonely and heartbroken - loses her closest companion and emotional strength - Burden of responsibility – of earning a livelihood and taking care of her family - Economic hardship - struggles to survive and faces financial insecurity - Social vulnerability - exploitation and disrespect in a male-dominated society - Strength and resilience - reveals her inner strength - determined, independent, and courageous in facing life's challenges. [An]/{CO4}
25. Iblis thrown out of heaven for disobeying the command of God - refused to bow to Adam, against God's command. [U]/CO3}
26. Both sentences are "culture- specific" - translator should have sufficient knowledge of the source culture - first sentence conveys the meaning - difficult for a non- Malayali reader to understand its cultural implications - second sentence uses translation strategy that is not purely linguistic but also cultural. ***Note**: **Response is subjective and marks can be given to appropriate answers***. [An]/{CO2}
27. N S Madhavan points out - Vijayan wrote the novels afresh in parts, selectively, choosing those areas where the authority of the day's political correctness in most domineering, namely sex and politics - not merely a question of political correctness - by the time Vijayan started translating Khasak his priorities had changed - had abandoned his sceptical, questioning attitude. [K]/{CO1}
28. Loss of self-control - Destruction of ambitions - Health problems, anxiety, depression, and emotional instability weaken the person - Addiction strains family, friendships, and social connections, causing isolation - Education, career, and social respect decline due to irresponsible behaviour - Financial crisis - money wasted on drugs - poverty and debt – Hopelessness - moral downfall - Severe addiction ultimately destroys life completely. [An]/{CO2}
29. Loneliness - unrequited love – pursuit of identity and belonging - sense of alienation in a rapidly changing world. [An]/ {CO3}
30. Livelihood loss - mechanized fishing reduces the catch of traditional fishermen - Environmental damage - modern development harms the sea and affects their survival - Cultural decline - traditional practices and community unity weaken under modern influences. [An]/{CO4}

[5x2 =10]

PART D

Short Essay Type Questions (150 Words)
Answer any 5 Questions. Each Question carries 5 marks

31.Foreignizing - a strategy where the translator deliberately retains the cultural and linguistic characteristics of the source text in a way that the work feels foreign to the target audience - authenticity and the uniqueness of the original work are preserved - at the risk of making the work challenging or less accessible to the target audience – Domesticating - involves adapting the text to the established norms and conventions of the target culture, making it look more familiar and acceptable to the audience - prioritizes readability and accessibility but may sacrifice some of the nuances and cultural richness of the original text. [U]/ {CO1}

32. Symbol of luxury and high social class - poor people trying to imitate the rich - modernization and loss of traditional values - sacred tusk used for fashion shows moral decay – toe grip of Kunjutachumma's sandals made from her father's elephant's tusk – matter of pride and past glory. [An]/{CO3}
33. Story of a fisherwoman's determination and helplessness - Symbol of female strength and ambition - struggles with gender and caste issues - Satyavathi stands for both power and loss of innocence –

sexual union with sage Parasara - compared to the fisherwoman Flory – rape - expose the sexual exploitation of women of the araya community. [An]/{CO4}

34. Structural shift – Shift in grammatical structure - For eg: The subject pronoun+verb+direct object structures of "I like Jazz" and "j'aime le jazz" in English and French are translated by an indirect object pronoun+verb+subject structure in Spanish (me gusta el jazz) and in Italian "mi piace il jazz" [U]/ {CO1}
35. 'Prethabhashanam' as a mix of story types - mixes romance, mystery, horror, and myth - narrated by a ghost - new viewpoint - full of emotion, drama, and suspense - shows human greed, guilt, and love - makes the story both interesting and meaningful. [An]/{CO2}
36. Exorcism scene in Kunjupattumma - superstition and fear in village life - people think Kunjupattumma is possessed - religious people use rituals and fear to control - reflects women's suffering and social ignorance - criticizes blind belief and cruelty in society. [K]/{CO3}
37. First-person ghost narration - adds mystery and emotion - creates suspense and sympathy - human guilt and regret after death - makes the story more deep and symbolic [An]/{CO2}
38. Value or meaning of translation can only be ascertained with reference to the entire field of literary production - translated text is constituted not only by the strategies of translation but also by the dialectics between the economic and symbolic capital in the culture of the target language - For eg the nature of addressivity in the fictional text of Khasak undergoes a complete change in translation - Malayalam original uses a large number of speech genres which may be traced to the caste difference in the lively subculture of a rural place - in its translation these dialects are rendered opaque and caste differences are projected onto religious differences - Cultural differences in translation - Translation is about culture and language together - some cultural words have no exact match - Translator must explain or recreate the idea - "Transcreation" – keeping both meaning and feeling - Translation becomes a bridge between two cultures. [U]/ {CO1}

[5x5 = 25]

PART E

Essay Type Questions

Answer any 1 Question in 300 Words. Each Question carries 15 marks.

39). Set in rural area-reflects local lifestyle, village life, and community relations - strong sense of family and ancestry - myth and exaggeration with humour - everyday life shaped by history and identity - Impact on translation - Cultural jokes need adaptation to make sense for new readers - Standardising language for clarity may remove the novel's unique voice - Idioms and figurative expressions-may need reinterpretation, not literal translation - maintaining the oral story telling rhythm in another language is complex. [An]/ {CO3}

40). Narrator's spirit possesses the lover's sister because her emotional bond with her lover remains incomplete - shows that love continues beyond death and does not end with physical loss - demonstrates how the dead continue to influence and haunt the living - after death, the narrator gains the power to speak the truth that was suppressed - provides release for both the dead and the living characters. [An]/ {CO2}

[1x15 =15]